📄 DOCUMENT 9

Vendor Engagement & Management Strategy

Hawassa MESOB One-Stop Service Center

Prepared For:
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PART 1

(Sections 1–5: Vendor Strategy Framework, Ethio Telecom Role Definition, Scope Boundaries, SLA Architecture, API Responsibility Clarification)

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1. VENDOR ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY OVERVIEW

The Hawassa MESOB One-Stop Service Center is a mission-critical governance reform program. Vendor engagement must therefore be:

- Contractually structured
- Technically explicit
- SLA-driven
- Performance-measured
- Risk-mitigated
- Exit-protected

The City must not enter into ambiguous package agreements.

The objective is to:

✓ Ensure infrastructure reliability
✓ Guarantee application performance
✓ Define API integration responsibility
✓ Protect public funds
✓ Maintain long-term vendor independence

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2. PRIMARY VENDOR ASSUMPTION: ETHIO TELECOM

It is anticipated that Ethio Telecom will serve as the primary infrastructure and managed services provider for the Hawassa MESOB Center.

Ethio Telecom's expected contribution areas may include:

- Fiber connectivity
- Data hosting
- Server infrastructure
- Cloud services
- Queue management system
- Security infrastructure
- Possibly API gateway platform

However:

Their exact scope must be formally defined in writing.

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3. DEFINING SCOPE BOUNDARIES

The most critical governance risk is unclear responsibility between:

- Infrastructure provider
- Application developer
- Bureau data owners
- National MESOB taskforce

Scope must be divided into four distinct domains.

3.1 Domain A – Physical & Network Infrastructure

Vendor Responsibility (Expected):

- Fiber provision
- Internet bandwidth
- Firewall installation
- Network configuration
- Server hosting
- UPS integration
- Basic cybersecurity perimeter

City Responsibility:

- Building renovation
- Internal civil works
- Physical security coordination

3.2 Domain B – Application Platform

Must clarify:

Does Ethio Telecom provide:

- Workflow engine?
- Case management system?
- API gateway?
- Authentication server?
- Database platform?

If yes:

Are these:

- Proprietary?
- Open-standard?
- Custom-built?
- Nationally standardized MESOB platform?

The contract must specify:

- Ownership of application code
- Customization rights

- Exit migration capability

3.3 Domain C – API Integration & Bureau Connectivity

This is the most critical unresolved issue.

There are three possible bureau conditions:

Scenario 1: Bureau Has Existing Digital System

Vendor Responsibility:

- Configure API gateway
- Connect bureau system
- Test endpoint

Bureau Responsibility:

- Provide API endpoint
- Ensure data accuracy

Scenario 2: Bureau Has Digital System but No API

Vendor may:

- Develop API wrapper
- Or provide middleware connector

Must be clearly priced.

Scenario 3: Bureau Has No System

This is the most complex case.

Options:

Option A: Ethio Telecom builds lightweight bureau endpoint
Option B: Hawassa City hires development team

Option C: Sidama Regional ICT Bureau builds endpoints
Option D: National MESOB Taskforce provides standardized module

This must be decided before procurement signing.

Otherwise, infrastructure will exist without functional service integration.

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4. SERVICE LEVEL AGREEMENT (SLA) ARCHITECTURE

SLA must be layered.

4.1 Infrastructure SLA

Must define:

- Uptime guarantee (≥ 99.5% minimum)
- Maximum downtime per month
- Response time for incidents
- Escalation hierarchy
- Financial penalty for breach

4.2 Application SLA

Must define:

- Maximum transaction processing time
- API response latency
- Bug resolution time
- Patch deployment window
- Upgrade notice period

4.3 Support SLA

Must define:

- 24/7 vs business-hours support
- On-site support response time
- Remote support escalation path
- Dedicated account manager requirement

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5. PERFORMANCE ACCOUNTABILITY FRAMEWORK

Vendor performance must be measurable.

5.1 Monthly Reporting Requirements

Vendor must submit:

- System uptime report
- Bandwidth utilization report
- API success/failure metrics
- Security incident report
- Backup verification report

5.2 Quarterly Governance Review

Mayor's Office must convene:

- Performance review meeting
- SLA compliance audit
- Financial reconciliation
- Risk review session

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6. VENDOR LOCK-IN PROTECTION

To prevent future dependency risk:

Contract must require:

- Data ownership retained by Hawassa City
- Open API standards (RESTful)
- Database export capability
- No proprietary data encryption blocking migration
- 90-day transition support clause upon contract termination

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7. PACKAGE CLARIFICATION REQUIREMENT

Ethio Telecom reportedly offers:

- Platinum package
- Standard package
- Basic package

The City must demand:

- Itemized breakdown per package
- Infrastructure components included
- Software modules included
- API integration included or excluded
- Hosting capacity limits
- SLA tier differences
- Upgrade cost between packages

No package may be accepted without line-item transparency.

PART 1 SUMMARY

This section established:

✓ Vendor governance framework
✓ Defined scope separation
✓ API responsibility clarification
✓ SLA structure
✓ Lock-in prevention strategy
✓ Package transparency requirements

Reply with:

“Proceed with Document 9, Part 2.”

Next we finalize:

✓ Risk-sharing model
✓ Payment structure
✓ Acceptance testing framework
✓ Implementation governance model
✓ Formal vendor engagement roadmap
✓ Recommended negotiation position for the Mayor.

📄 DOCUMENT 9

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PART 2
(Sections 6–11: Risk-Sharing Model, Payment Structure, Acceptance Framework, Governance Structure, Negotiation Position, Formal Engagement Roadmap)

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6. RISK-SHARING MODEL

The MESOB program must not transfer all risk to Hawassa City.

Risk must be contractually distributed between:

- Hawassa City Administration
- Ethio Telecom
- Local bureaus
- Regional/National MESOB stakeholders

6.1 Infrastructure Risk

Risk Type: Network downtime, hosting outage, bandwidth degradation
Owner: Vendor

Contract must specify:

- Financial penalty per hour of downtime beyond SLA
- Automatic service credit
- Escalation to executive level after threshold breach

6.2 Application Performance Risk

Risk Type: Slow system, API failures, system crash

If vendor provides application layer:

Vendor assumes responsibility.

If third party builds application:

Responsibility must be split explicitly between:

- Infrastructure layer
- Application layer

No “gray zone” allowed.

6.3 Bureau Integration Risk

If bureau does not deliver API endpoint on time:

Responsibility lies with bureau.

However, if vendor fails to:

- Provide integration guidance
- Deliver middleware
- Support testing

Vendor shares risk.

This must be formalized in integration milestone plan.

6.4 Data Loss Risk

Vendor must guarantee:

- Automated daily backup
- Geo-redundant replication (if cloud)
- Backup restoration testing every quarter

Data ownership remains with Hawassa City.

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7. PAYMENT STRUCTURE MODEL

Payments must be milestone-based.

Never full upfront.

7.1 Recommended Payment Phases

Phase 1 – Contract Signing (10–15%)

Phase 2 – Infrastructure Delivery & Installation (25%)

Phase 3 – Application Deployment & Configuration (20%)

Phase 4 – Integration Completion (20%)

Phase 5 – Acceptance & Go-Live (15%)

Phase 6 – After 90 Days of Stable Operation (10%)

This ensures performance-based disbursement.

7.2 OPEX Payment Terms

Operational payments (hosting, bandwidth, support) must:

- Be monthly or quarterly
- Include SLA penalty deduction mechanism
- Have fixed escalation cap

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8. SYSTEM ACCEPTANCE & TESTING FRAMEWORK

No system must be accepted without formal testing.

8.1 Infrastructure Acceptance Test

Checklist:

- Network redundancy verified
- Firewall rules tested
- Backup link tested
- Power failover tested
- UPS runtime validated

8.2 Application Acceptance Test

Checklist:

- All 47 Phase 1 services configured
- Workflow functioning
- API calls verified
- Audit logs captured
- User access roles validated

8.3 Performance Stress Testing

Simulate:

- 1,500 daily transactions
- Peak-hour load spike
- Concurrent service counter usage

Response time must remain within SLA threshold.

8.4 Security Testing

- Vulnerability scan
- Penetration test (recommended)
- Access control audit
- Encryption validation

Acceptance certificate must be signed only after full validation.

9. IMPLEMENTATION GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

To ensure structured delivery, a governance body must be formed.

9.1 MESOB Steering Committee

Chair: Mayor or delegated Deputy
Members:

- City ICT Head
- Finance Head
- Legal Advisor
- Representative from Sidama Regional ICT
- Vendor Project Director

9.2 Technical Working Group

Responsible for:

- Weekly implementation tracking
- Integration monitoring
- Issue resolution
- Change control management

9.3 Change Management Protocol

Any change to:

- Scope
- Budget
- Timeline
- Integration design

Must be approved by Steering Committee.

No informal changes.

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10. RECOMMENDED NEGOTIATION POSITION FOR THE MAYOR

The Mayor's negotiation posture should be:

Firm, structured, and documentation-driven.

10.1 Key Demands

1. Full itemized breakdown of Platinum, Standard, Basic packages
2. Clear written definition of API integration responsibility
3. Defined SLA with penalties
4. CAPEX vs OPEX separation
5. 3-year cost projection
6. Exit & migration clause

10.2 Non-Negotiable Points

- Data ownership remains with Hawassa City
- Open API standard compliance
- Transparent pricing
- Performance-based payment structure
- Bureau integration clarity

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11. FORMAL VENDOR ENGAGEMENT ROADMAP

Step 1: Send Technical Clarification Letter
Step 2: Receive Package Breakdown
Step 3: Conduct Technical Workshop
Step 4: Align Scope Against Document 4 & 6 Architecture

Step 5: Issue Revised BoQ Confirmation
Step 6: Negotiate SLA & Risk Clauses
Step 7: Contract Finalization
Step 8: Controlled Implementation Launch

FINAL DOCUMENT CONCLUSION

With Documents 1–9 completed, Hawassa City now possesses:

✓ Strategic alignment with national MESOB
✓ Defined Phase 1 & Phase 2 services
✓ Technical architecture
✓ Building infrastructure plan
✓ Full procurement blueprint
✓ Vendor governance model
✓ SLA & risk protection framework

This positions Hawassa to:

Move from planning → structured procurement → controlled implementation → operational MESOB launch.

MASTER DOCUMENT SERIES COMPLETE

If you would like next:

- Executive Mayor Presentation Version (Condensed 20–25 slide format)
- Formal Contract Draft Template
- Risk & Control Matrix (Expanded Audit Version)
- Implementation Timeline Gantt Blueprint
- Full Financial Modeling Sheet Structure

Please specify which one to generate next.